

Discussion on Frontend Development

17-316/616 Fall 2025

AI Tools for Software Development

<https://ai-developer-tools.github.io>

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Reflection prompts this week

1. What is the difference between one-shot and multi-shot prompting in an LLM? Discuss one advantage and one disadvantage from your experiences with the LLMs in Figma, Cursor, Claude, and ChatGPT.
2. Discuss the challenges of getting the LLM to create a multi-part front end design or implementation? Describe the difficulties in ensuring 1) correctness of each part, 2) consistency across the parts, and 3) accuracy of the results matching your intentions. Tell us how you would test, validate, and refine the outputs.
3. Discuss the legal and ethical implications of an LLM inadvertently helping you to design a UI that looks like a clone of another application. Have this happened to you before? Have you heard of this happening to others? What would you do if you got an email from the originator of your project's startup saying they saw your clone?
4. How should an LLM enable you and a colleague to collaborate on the design of a single front end application without both of you typing into the same computer prompt? Speculate on your ideal collaborative system design.
5. How might the use of LLMs in front-end development change the skills that future developers need to learn? Which skills become more important (e.g., prompt engineering, critical evaluation, system thinking) and which might become less central?
6. How do you get the LLM to generate half an application, where the other half is not only not yet specified, but not even designed?

Discussion Instructions

- Instructor announces the reflection question.
- If you chose this reflection question to answer for homework, come up to the front. You are the discussant group.
- Class forms into pairs.
- Pairs and discussant group should now reflect on the question by themselves (4 min)
 - Explain what you think, why, and how you've come to your conclusions.
- Each discussant explains their answer to the class (3-4 min)
- Instructor will choose a pair to report their answer to the class (1 min)
- A discussant will respond and connect the answer to their own reflection (1 min)

Reflection Prompt

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Next Class

- Backend Development!
- P3: Frontend Development due 11:59pm tonight.